

NEBULA:FOG 2026

Judge Scoring Reference Card

SCORING OVERVIEW

0 - 10

SCORE RANGE

70 / 30

AI / HUMAN BLEND

3 + 1

CRITERIA + TRACK BONUS

Each criterion is scored 0-10. The final score is the weighted average of general criteria scores plus any applicable track bonus. The AI judge score is blended 70/30 with the human judge score.

CALIBRATION ANCHORS

RANGE	CALIBRATION
9 - 10	Exceptional - Among the best you've seen. Sets a new standard.
7 - 8	Strong - Clearly above average, notable quality with minor gaps.
5 - 6	Adequate - Meets baseline expectations, nothing remarkable.
3 - 4	Below Average - Significant shortcomings, partially delivered.
1 - 2	Poor - Fundamental failures, barely attempted or broken.

GENERAL CRITERIA

Technical Execution

40%

Implementation quality, functionality, complexity, code correctness, edge case handling

- 9 - 10 Flawless implementation, production-quality, handles edge cases
- 7 - 8 Solid implementation with minor gaps
- 5 - 6 Functional but rough, obvious shortcuts
- 3 - 4 Partially working, significant bugs
- 1 - 2 Barely functional or broken

Innovation

30%

AI x Security novelty, creative approaches, original thinking

- 9 - 10 Groundbreaking novel approach
- 7 - 8 Clearly innovative with unique angle
- 5 - 6 Some novelty but mostly established techniques
- 3 - 4 Incremental or derivative
- 1 - 2 No discernible innovation

Demo Quality

30%

Clear explanation, working live demo, effective presentation, compelling narrative

- 9 - 10 Flawless live demo, masterful explanation, compelling narrative
- 7 - 8 Solid demo with good explanation, minor hiccups
- 5 - 6 Demo works but explanation unclear or rushed
- 3 - 4 Demo partially works, confusing presentation
- 1 - 2 Demo fails or no meaningful demonstration

TRACK BONUSES

TRACK	BONUS CRITERION	DESCRIPTION	WEIGHT
SHADOW::VECTOR	Attack Effectiveness	Novelty and effectiveness of attack approach, responsible disclosure consideration	+10%
SENTINEL::MESH	Defense Robustness	Real-world applicability of defense, detection accuracy, hardening effectiveness	+10%
ZERO::PROOF	Privacy Guarantees	Cryptographic soundness, privacy preservation completeness, verification integrity	+10%
ROGUE::AGENT	Originality Factor	Ambition relative to time constraint, exploration of uncharted territory	+10%

NOTE: EXTENDED CRITERIA VARIANT

4-Criterion Variant: An extended rubric may be used matching the nebulafog.ai website, splitting into Technical Execution (30%), Innovation (25%), Impact (20%), and Demo Quality

(25%). The AI judge's **ScoringEngine** accepts an optional criteria parameter to switch between variants. The calibration anchors and track bonuses remain unchanged.